

CURRICULUM VITAE – MINDA ZHAO

CONTACT	Minda Zhao Email : mindazhao@gatech.edu Website : https://minda-zhao.github.io/Personal-Website Phone : +1 470-303-3944 Address : Room 422, ISyE Main Building, 755 Ferst Dr NW, Atlanta, GA 30332		
EDUCATION	● Georgia Institute of Technology (Gatech) Atlanta, GA <i>Ph.D. student in Operations Research</i> 2022 - 2027 (Expected) – Advisor : Prof. Xin Chen ● University of Illinois, Urbana-Champaign (UIUC) Champaign, IL <i>Ph.D. student in Industrial Engineering</i> 2021 - 2022 – Transferred to Georgia Institute of Technology. ● University of Chicago (UChicago) Chicago, IL <i>M.S. in Computational and Applied Mathematics</i> 2019 - 2020 – Advisor : Prof. Lek-Heng Lim ● Sun Yat-sen University (SYSU) Guangzhou, China <i>B.S. in Information and Computing Science</i> 2015 - 2019		
RESEARCH INTEREST	Methodology : Stochastic Programming, Nonconvex Optimization. Application : Operations Models, Optimal Control, Reinforcement Learning.		
PREPRINTS	1. Hidden Convexity in Queueing Models. [ArXiv] [SSRN] Xin Chen, Linwei Xin, Minda Zhao (alphabetical order) – Under major revision at <i>Operations Research</i>. 2. A Simple Solution to Improving Human Supervision of Algorithms : Evidence from Smart Vending. [SSRN] Minda Zhao, Brian Han, Xin Chen, Tao Zhu – Under major revision at <i>Manufacturing & Service Operations Management</i>. – Finalist, CBOM Junior Scholar Paper Competition, 2026. – Selected as an oral presentation at MSOM Supply Chain SIG 2025. – Third Place, CSAMSE Practice Award 2024. 3. Landscape of Policy Optimization for Finite Horizon MDPs with General State and Action. [ArXiv] Xin Chen, Yifan Hu, Minda Zhao (alphabetical order) – Under revision at <i>Operations Research</i>. – Extended abstract accepted by NeurIPS 2025 ML×OR Workshop.		
PUBLICATIONS	1. Stochastic Steffensen Method. [Link] Minda Zhao, Zehua Lai, Lek-Heng Lim. 2024 <i>Computational Optimization and Applications</i>, pp.1-32.		
HONORS AND AWARDS	● Shabbir Ahmed PhD Fellowship for Excellence in Research 2025 – Awarded annually to up to two Ph.D. students in Georgia Tech ISyE for research in optimization ● Third Place, CSAMSE Practice Award 2024 ● NCCR Automation Fellowship, Switzerland 2024 ● Hansen Fellowship, UIUC 2021 ● Merit Undergraduate Thesis, SYSU 2019 ● First-class Scholarship, SYSU 2018		
TEACHING	● Guest Lecturer, Georgia Tech Spring 2025 Optimization and Learning in Operations (ISyE 8803) – Instructor : Xin Chen – Responsibility : 4 Lectures in policy gradient methods and nonconvex optimization		

CONFERENCE
PRESENTATIONS

- **Hidden Convexity in Queueing Models.**
 - (Poster) Cornell Young Researchers Workshop, Ithaca, NY Oct 2025
- **A Simple Solution to Improving Human Supervision of Algorithms : Evidence from Smart Vending.**
 - INFORMS MSOM Conference, Supply Chain Management SIG, London, UK Jun 2025
 - Annual POMS Conference, Atlanta, GA May 2025
 - Conference on Digital Experimentation @ MIT, Boston, MA Oct 2024
- **Landscape of Policy Optimization for Finite Horizon MDPs with General State and Action.**
 - (Poster) NeurIPS 2025 ML×OR Workshop, San Diego, CA Dec 2025
 - INFORMS Annual Meeting, Atlanta, GA Oct 2025
 - International Conference on Continuous Optimization, Los Angeles, CA Jul 2025
 - INFORMS RMP Section Conference, New York, NY Jul 2025
 - INFORMS APS Conference, Atlanta, GA Jun 2025
 - IISE Annual Conference & Expo, Atlanta, GA Jun 2025
 - Annual POMS Conference, Atlanta, GA May 2025
 - INFORMS Annual Meeting, Seattle, WA Oct 2024
 - (Poster) Cornell Young Researchers Workshop, Ithaca, NY Oct 2024
 - Purdue Operations Conference, West Lafayette, IN Aug 2024
 - INFORMS Annual Meeting, Phoenix, AZ Oct 2023
 - International Annual Conference of CSAMSE, Shenzhen, China Jul 2023

SERVICES

- **Session Organization :**
 - International Conference on Continuous Optimization (ICCOPT 2025) Jul 2025
 - Session : Recent Advances in Optimization for MDPs and Stochastic Optimal Control
- **Reviewer :**
 - *Operations Research*
 - *Management Science*
 - *Computational Optimization and Applications*

INDUSTRY
EXPERIENCE

- **Shenzhen Fengyi Technology Co., Ltd.** Shenzhen, China
 - Research Assistant (remote)* Mar 2022 - Present
 - Research Scientist Intern* Jul 2023 - Aug 2023
 - Developed and implemented a new replenishment strategy, reducing annual inventory costs by \$1,000,000.
- **Cainiao Network** Hangzhou, China
 - Research Scientist Intern* Jun 2021 – Oct 2021

REFERENCES

- **Xin Chen (Professor)**
 - H. Milton Stewart School of Industrial and Systems Engineering, Georgia Tech
 - Email : xin.chen@isye.gatech.edu
- **Linwei Xin (Associate Professor)**
 - School of Operations Research and Information Engineering, Cornell University
 - Email : lx267@cornell.edu
- **Guanghai (George) Lan (Professor)**
 - H. Milton Stewart School of Industrial and Systems Engineering, Georgia Tech
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